7HE H0LY R3UP



CORNER TO CROWN

Five Founding Days from the 30-Day Rebuild

A trauma-informed workbook, devotional & coloring book
for the woman still standing between “I can’t keep living like this” and “what do I do next.”

You survived. Now we rebuild.

by Hellshaker · Created October 24, 2026

Copyright & Care

Corner to Crown: Five Founding Days from the 30-Day Rebuild
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Please read this part

This book is not therapy, medical care, addiction treatment, legal advice, or a crisis service. The author is a survivor and a friend. She is not a licensed counselor, physician, or pastor, and surviving something does not make anyone qualified to treat somebody else. This book is meant to sit *beside* real care, never replace it.

Never stop or change a prescribed medication, including medication for opioid or alcohol use disorder, because of anything in this book. Talk to your prescriber. Some withdrawals are medically dangerous. Get medical help.

Prayer sits beside practical care. It does not replace treatment, safe housing, a safety plan, or emergency help.

About the ancient texts. Some pages draw on 1 Enoch and Jubilees, which belong to the canon of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church. Other Christian traditions do not receive them as Scripture. Every claim in this book carries a small tag so you can always see what kind of claim it is:

- **S** Scripture (ESV), quoted or cited from the 66-book Bible.
- **E** Ethiopian canon text. Read as an ancient source, with chapter references.
- **A** The author’s interpretation or practical application. Weigh it. Test it against Scripture and with people you trust.
- **T** Personal testimony.

The coloring pages are symbolic. A broken chain, a fence, or a jar on a page is a picture to help you practice. Coloring or writing on a page does not literally break a curse or change spiritual reality. It is a way to slow down, tell the truth, and choose a next step.

If you are in danger now: call or text 911 (U.S.). Suicide & Crisis Lifeline: call or text 988. See the last page for more numbers.

Contents

Copyright & Care 2

What's Ahead 4

How to Use This Book (Read This First) 5

Introduction: Somebody Who Remembers the Floor 6

THE FIVE FOUNDING DAYS

Day 4 The Watcher Template 7

Sanctuary & Teaching · Template Spotter · Reflection & Prayer · Coloring Page

Day 9 The Leash 11

Sanctuary & Teaching · Sort the Jars · Reflection & Prayer · Coloring Page

Day 14 Legal Ground & Fence Lines 15

Sanctuary & Teaching · Loop Map & Quit-Claim · Reflection & Prayer · Coloring Page

Day 17 Numb Was a Teacher 19

Sanctuary & Teaching · Job Interview for the Habit · Reflection & Prayer · Coloring Page

Day 27 Won't Bow 23

Sanctuary & Teaching · Pressure Ladder · Reflection & Prayer · Coloring Page

FINISHING WELL

Final Reflection & Progress Review 27

Next-Step Challenge & Closing Prayer 28

7HE H0LY R3UP Certificate of Completion 29

Where to Reach a Real Human (Resources) 30

These five days are numbered the way they will sit inside the full 30-day book, so you may notice gaps. Nothing is missing. You are not behind.

What's Ahead

Each day has the same four parts, so you always know where you are:

1. **Sanctuary & Teaching.** A short, optional grounding exercise and a prayer for presence, then one passage and what it actually says.
2. **The Tool.** A worksheet, diagnostic, or flowchart. This is where you practice.
3. **Sacred Reflection, Soft Action & Supplication.** Three honest prompts with room to write, one realistic step, and a prayer for when you can't find your own words.
4. **A Coloring Page.** Heavy lines, big shapes, no deadline. Color it while you breathe.

Day	The truth we're facing	The tool	What you'll color
4	Control follows a script. Once you can see it, it loses some of its fog.	Template Spotter	A hexagon, an open jar, five bubbles
9	Not every bad night is an attack. Opposition is real, and it is limited.	Sort the Jars	Four jars on a ground line
14	Some of what's in your house was handed to you. Some you agreed to. You can tell the difference.	Loop Map & Quit-Claim	Three fence lines and a jar
17	Numbing was doing a job. Find out which job.	Job Interview for the Habit	A pruned vine and its roots
27	You can refuse to bow without announcing it to a dangerous person.	Pressure Ladder	A standing stone, a cross, an anchor, a crown

You can do these in order or in whatever order your life lets you. You can do one a week or one a year. A day you skip is not a day you failed.

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit." **Psalm 34:18 (ESV)** S

How to Use This Book (Read This First)

- **You are allowed to skip anything.** Any exercise, any prompt, any page. Skipping is a boundary, not a failure.
- **Keep your eyes open if closing them feels unsafe.** Every grounding exercise works with eyes open. Pick a different anchor if mine doesn't work: a cold glass, a coin, the feel of your shirt.
- **You never have to write your story.** Nothing in this book asks you to relive anything or tell all of it. Use initials. Use "someone." Use a color instead of a name.
- **Protect this book.** If anyone who has hurt you might read it, keep it somewhere safe, write in pencil or in code, or take photos of the pages and keep it off your phone's main gallery. Your safety comes before your journaling.
- **If a page stirs up too much,** put the pen down. Press your feet into the floor. Drink some water. Color a page. Text a safe person. If you feel unsafe, call 988 or 911.
- **If you're using or craving,** don't wait to be "ready" for this book. Call SAMHSA's helpline: 1-800-662-4357 (free, confidential, 24/7). Don't stop alcohol or some other substances suddenly without medical advice. Withdrawal can be dangerous.
- **Money, housing, and transportation are real.** Every soft action here is built to cost nothing. If one is out of reach, change it. I'd rather you adapt a step than quit the book.
- **Look at the tags.** S E A T show you what kind of claim you're reading. I want you to know when it's Scripture and when it's me.

THREE LENSES WE'LL USE

#human is what this feels like in a real body and a real life.
#truthmode is what's true, what Scripture supports, and what needs confronting.
#futureyou is what repeated small choices can build: peace, stability, responsibility, and a mature faith.

Introduction: Somebody Who Remembers the Floor

I’m not writing this from a pedestal. I’m writing it from the floor, and I’m still building.

I lost my sister to addiction. I’ve survived homelessness, trafficking, abuse, and years inside a destructive relationship where somebody else decided what was true. There was a stretch when I was alone, scared of people, and not sure I could trust anybody. T

When I reached for help, I sometimes found strings attached. I met people who could quote Scripture and still see somebody’s wounds as an opportunity. I got handed a watered-down verse and told to pray it away. I needed somewhere that could hold the truth about trauma without pushing God out of the room. I wish my sister had somewhere like that to reach. I can’t say it would have changed her outcome. I can say I’m building toward making that kind of help easier for somebody who’s still here.

My American Bully, Big Boy, stood beside me on some of my loneliest days. God met me while I was still trying to get up. That’s where this book comes from: a woman, her battle buddy, and a faith being lived out in the middle of rebuilding.

I’m not a counselor. I haven’t arrived. What I have is what I’ve learned, what Scripture actually teaches, and something practical you can do with a pen on a hard day.

You’ll notice I bring in some old books that not every church reads: 1 Enoch and Jubilees, which the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church counts as Scripture. I do it because they give us sharp pictures of how harm works, how limited the enemy’s reach is, and why boundaries matter. I’ll always tell you where a claim comes from, and I’ll tell you when it’s only my application. I won’t put words in God’s mouth, and I won’t tell you every hard thing is an attack. Understanding isn’t excusing. Grace isn’t enabling. Forgiveness doesn’t automatically bring back trust or access. Recovery doesn’t require pretending.

The streets taught some of us a language. I’m flipping it holy. Re-up means returning for renewal. The trap is a pattern that keeps taking more than it gives. Bando to vineyard means moving from surviving the day toward tending a life. Corner to crown means you were never only the role you survived in. It’s a picture, not a promise of instant change. A vineyard takes pruning and patience and years.

Brokenness isn’t the destination. You survived. Now we rebuild.

— Hellshaker

DAY 4

The Watcher Template

He came down looking like help. He left you owing.

S John 8:44; Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 · E 1 Enoch 6–8, 15 · #truthmode

SANCTUARY (optional · 2 minutes)

Find three things you can see in the room. Say them quietly. Press your feet into the floor. Breathe in, then let the breath out longer than it came in. Do that twice. Keep your eyes open if that's safer. If today is too heavy, skip to the coloring page. That counts.

God, I don't know if it's safe in here. Be here anyway. Help me look at this without being swallowed by it. Amen.

> "He was a murderer from the beginning, and has nothing to do with the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he lies, he speaks out of his own character, for he is a liar and the father of lies." **John 8:44 (ESV)** S
>
> "Two are better than one… For if they fall, one will lift up his fellow. But woe to him who is alone when he falls and has not another to lift him up!" **Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 (ESV)** S

I know why you stayed. You weren't stupid. You were loyal to the version of them that showed up first. #human

The oldest story in the Ethiopian Orthodox canon about how harm moves is 1 Enoch. E Chapters 6–8 tell of the Watchers, beings assigned to watch who instead came down by their own choice, took what was not offered, and taught things that bound people. Chapter 7 says the violence spread until it turned on humanity itself, and chapter 15 says the spirits that came out of that wreckage became evil spirits on earth. The Ethiopian church counts Enoch as Scripture, and Jude 14–15 quotes it (1 Enoch 1:9). S E I'm using it as a map of a *pattern*, not as a formula.

Here's the pattern, in street words: **come down looking like help, take what wasn't offered, hand over something that binds, cut off whoever might notice, leave a mess others pay for.** A Jesus says the enemy is a liar, and lying works best when it comes with access. #truthmode

Isolation is the load-bearing wall. Ecclesiastes says God built us to be picked up when we fall, so anything that removes the person who'd pick you up is doing the enemy's work, whether it comes from a spirit or a spouse. Clinicians describe this with terms like *coercive control* and *trauma bonding*: attachment that gets stronger through cycles of harm and relief. A I'm naming behaviors, not diagnosing anybody. Only a clinician diagnoses.

Two guardrails. People are responsible for what they choose, so you don't have to call anyone demonic to call the harm real, and "the devil made me" excuses nothing. And understanding the pattern isn't the same as agreeing to go back to it.

Truths to stand on: Staying was survival, not stupidity. · I can name what happened without calling myself a fool. · Understanding why I stayed is not agreeing to go back.

Template Spotter

This is pattern-spotting, not people-labeling. Circle or check everything that fits. Use initials or "someone." If you aren't safe, skip this page and use the numbers on the last page.

1. Descent	*It started with...* ☐ intense attention and gifts ☐ rescuing me ☐ a crisis only they could fix ☐ other: _____
2. Taking	*They took...* ☐ my phone, passwords, or money ☐ my time ☐ my body or my choices ☐ other: _____
3. Teaching	*They taught me...* ☐ a habit or substance we shared ☐ rules I had to follow ☐ that I was the problem ☐ other: _____
4. Cutting off	*I got cut off from...* ☐ friends or family ☐ church or support ☐ anyone who might notice ☐ other: _____
5. Aftermath	*What I'm left with...* ☐ debt ☐ fear ☐ people I love who were hurt ☐ other: _____

COUNT IT UP

3 or more stages checked means you're looking at a *pattern*, not a bad week. That is information, not a verdict on you.

The first thing I gave away without realizing it was _____

The first person I stopped calling was _____

One person who might still pick up is _____

If that last line stays blank today, that's honest. Write "I'm working on it" and keep going.

WHAT I'M NOTICING (optional)

DAY 4 SACRED REFLECTION

There are no wrong answers here. Anger, doubt, and grief are allowed. You can tell God the truth before you know how to clean it up.

1. What did “help” look like the first time it showed up? What did I need back then?

2. What did I give away before I realized it was gone?

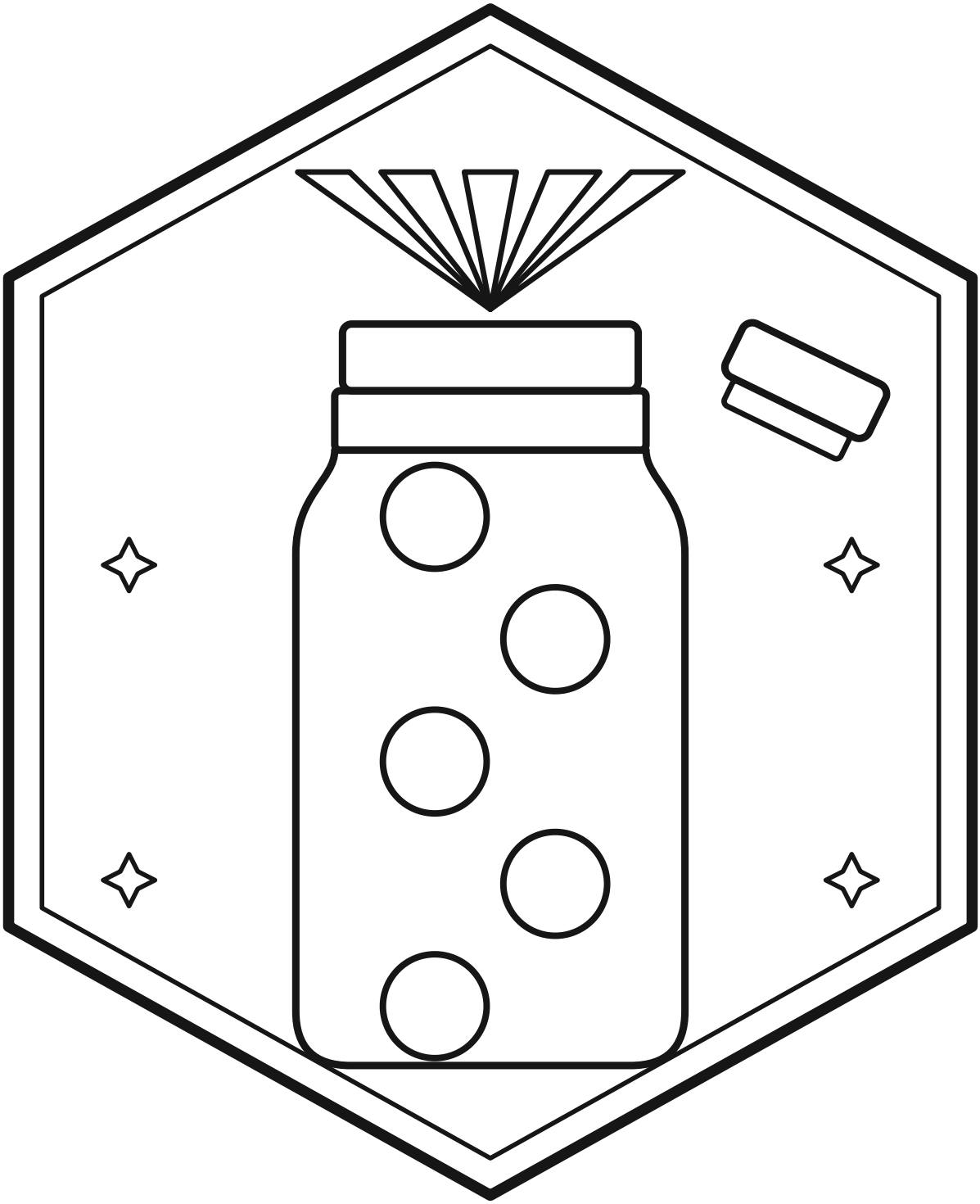
3. Where am I angry? Tell God the unclean version. He can take it.

SOFT ACTION (one step, not five)

Contact **one** person from your list with a single line: “Thinking of you.” That’s it. If reaching out isn’t safe, tell a hotline advocate (1-800-799-7233) or a counselor instead. If someone could read this book, use initials only.

SUPPLICATION · A PRAYER FOR WHEN YOU CAN’T FIND THE WORDS

Father, You saw it before I could name it. Thank You that You aren’t surprised by what happened to me. I’m tired of carrying the blame that belongs to the people who chose it. Help me tell the truth without hating myself. Bring one safe person into my reach this week. Where I’m angry, hold me while I say it. Where I’m numb, be patient with me. I don’t have the words, so take these: stay close. In the name of Jesus, amen.



Let the light out. "Resist him, firm in your faith, knowing that the same kind of sufferings are being experienced by your brotherhood throughout the world." ***1 Peter 5:9 (ESV)***

Color slowly or not at all. Keep your eyes open. Breathe out longer than you breathe in. There is no right way to do this.

DAY 9

The Leash

You are not being hunted by something with no limits.

S Job 1:12; 1 Kings 19:5–8; 1 Peter 5:8–9; James 4:7 · E Jubilees 10:1–13 · #truthmode

SANCTUARY (optional · 2 minutes)

Hold something cold or textured: a glass of water, a coin, a rock. Notice its weight. Notice its temperature. Name what you're feeling in one word, out loud or in your head. You don't have to fix the word. Just name it.

Lord, I'm tired and I'm scared and I don't know what's what. Sort it with me. Amen.

> "And the LORD said to Satan, 'Behold, all that he has is in your hand. Only against him do not stretch out your hand.' So Satan went out from the presence of the LORD." **Job 1:12 (ESV)** S
>
> "Submit yourselves therefore to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you." **James 4:7 (ESV)** S

At rock bottom, everything feels like one big attack. I remember that. And that's exactly where you can lose the thread. #human

The Book of Jubilees, in the Ethiopian canon, has a scene after the flood: Noah's grandchildren are being led astray, and Noah prays. The spirits are bound, but Mastema, the chief of them, pleads to keep some. The account says one tenth were left under him and the rest were bound (Jubilees 10:8–9). E The same chapter says angels taught Noah to heal with plants (10:10–13). E Job 1:12 shows the same shape in the 66-book Bible: the adversary acts only inside limits God sets. S

My application: **the enemy has a leash.** A That isn't a percentage of your life. It means opposition is real and it is limited, and Peter says to be sober-minded and watchful and to resist, not to panic (1 Peter 5:8–9). S

Now look at what God does first for Elijah, who is exhausted, afraid, and wants to die. An angel doesn't cast out anything. He says, "Arise and eat," and Elijah sleeps, eats, and drinks before anything else (1 Kings 19:5–8). S **Body first.** A

So I don't start with "who's attacking me?" I start with the jars: body, other people, my own choices. Only after those do I ask whether something spiritual is still pressing. Not every bad night is an attack. Calling everything demonic can keep you from sleep, food, medication, and real help, and it can excuse harm people chose. It also doesn't remove your responsibility for what you do next.

Truths to stand on: Opposition is real and it is limited. · My body is allowed to need rest. · I don't have to figure out everything tonight.

Sort the Jars

For any hard moment, work down the jars in order. Stop at the first one that's true and do what it says.

1. **Body jar.** Have I slept? Eaten? Had water? Is this withdrawal, panic, pain, or a medical issue?
   ▶ Yes / maybe: feed, hydrate, rest, call a doctor or SAMHSA (1-800-662-4357). Do this first.

2. **Others jar.** Did someone's choice cause this?
   ▶ Yes: name it honestly. Grief and safety come before spiritual language. It is not your fault.

3. **My choices jar.** Am I repeating something I know costs me?
   ▶ Yes: confess it (1 John 1:9) and choose one different move. Not shame. One move.

4. **Opposition jar** *(smallest, last)*. After 1–3, does something still feel like it's pressing against my freedom?
   ▶ Yes: pray James 4:7. Tell a safe believer. Don't carry it alone. Keep caring for jars 1–3.

Tonight I'm starting at jar # _____. The one thing within my reach is _____

The last time I slept and ate decently was _____. Today's plan for that: _____

One person who can sit with me on jar 4, if it comes to that: _____

1 John 1:9 (ESV) S: "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."

WHAT EACH JAR SHOWED ME TONIGHT (optional)

DAY 9 SACRED REFLECTION

There are no wrong answers here. Anger, doubt, and grief are allowed. You can tell God the truth before you know how to clean it up.

1. Which jar do I usually skip, and why do I think I skip it?

2. When did “everything is an attack” last keep me from taking care of my body or asking for help?

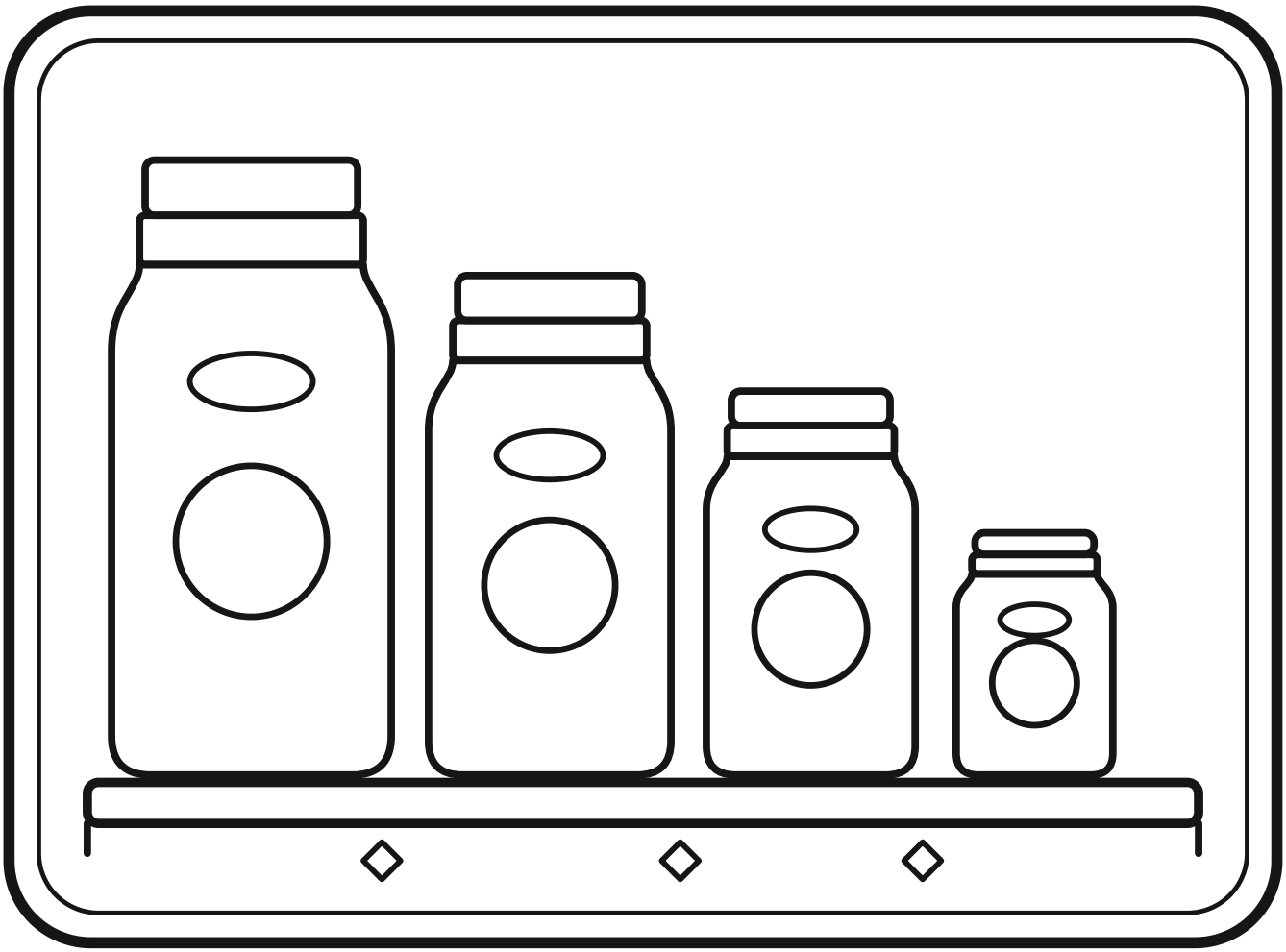
3. What would it look like to treat myself the way God treated Elijah?

SOFT ACTION (one step, not five)

Eat something and drink water. Pick a bedtime and write it here: _____. If you’re cutting back or stopping a substance, **call a doctor or SAMHSA first**, because stopping some substances suddenly can be dangerous.

SUPPLICATION · A PRAYER FOR WHEN YOU CAN’T FIND THE WORDS

God, thank You that the enemy has limits and You don’t. I’m so tired I can’t tell what’s what. Help me feed this body, sleep when I can, and tell the truth about what’s mine and what isn’t. Where I need a doctor, a friend, or a counselor, bring them to me. Where I need to resist, give me courage and company. Let me hear “arise and eat” as kindness. In Jesus’ name, amen.



Biggest jar first. "Arise and eat, for the journey is too great for you." ***1 Kings 19:7 (ESV)***

Color slowly or not at all. Keep your eyes open. Breathe out longer than you breathe in. There is no right way to do this.

DAY 14

Legal Ground & Fence Lines

Some things in your house aren't yours. You can finally say so.

S Ephesians 4:26–27; Ezekiel 18:20; Colossians 2:14; 2 Corinthians 2:11 · E Jubilees 8–10 · #truthmode

SANCTUARY (optional · 2 minutes)

Press your palms hard against your knees, or against a wall, for ten seconds. Then let go. Notice what your body does when it lets go. That's the feeling we're practicing: pressing hard against something, and then setting it down.

Lord, show me what's mine and what's not. Give me honest eyes and gentle hands. Amen.

> "Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun go down on your anger, and give no opportunity to the devil." **Ephesians 4:26–27 (ESV)** S
>
> "The soul who sins shall die. The son shall not suffer for the iniquity of the father, nor the father suffer for the iniquity of the son." **Ezekiel 18:20 (ESV)** S

There's a difference between what was done *to* you and what you agreed to. Nobody told me that, and it cost me years. #human

The Greek word translated "opportunity" in Ephesians 4:27 is *topos*, a place or a spot. S Paul's picture is that unresolved things can become room we leave open. The Book of Jubilees is obsessed with places: who was allotted which land, where boundaries sat, and the consequences when someone settled where he wasn't supposed to (chapters 8–10, including 10:29–34). E I'm borrowing that language as a **picture**: fence lines, gates, ground. A

What kinds of ground do we leave open? Anger carried for years. Secrets we promised to keep. Inner vows like "I'll never need anybody." Habits we run on autopilot. Lies about ourselves we never checked. A

Now the hard part, and I won't water it down. Exodus 20:5 says the consequences of sin can ripple to the third and fourth generation. Ezekiel 18:20 says guilt is not inherited, and a child is not condemned for a parent's sin. S Both are true at once. **Patterns travel through homes** (what was modeled, feared, or kept quiet). Research on childhood stress points the same way: coping gets learned. **But you aren't sentenced.** What was learned can be unlearned, with help. A

Colossians 2:14 says Christ cancelled "the record of debt that stood against us with its legal demands," nailing it to the cross. S So this isn't paperwork you file to earn anything. The tool on the next page is **practice**, a way to tell the truth and choose a different response. It doesn't literally break a curse. A counselor or pastor can walk it with you.

Truths to stand on: What was done to me is not mine to carry. · I can end an agreement I made in the dark. · Surrender goes to God, never to someone who hurt me.

Loop Map & Quit-Claim

Part 1 · Loop Map. Use words like silence, rage, leaving, using, control, performing, fear. Stop whenever you want.

	The pattern I saw	What it protected them from	What it costs me now
Grandparents / elders			
Parents / caregivers			
Me			

Part 2 · Quit-Claim. (A quit-claim is a plain document where you stop claiming something.) Fill in both columns. The second column matters as much as the first.

I give back to God	I am NOT surrendering
A vow I made: _____	My safety: _____
A secret I agreed to keep: _____	My prescribed medication or treatment: _____
A resentment I'm still renting: _____	My right to say no: _____
A habit I'm done defending: _____	My boundary with: _____

Surrender to God is not surrender to a person who harms you. Forgiveness does not require reconciliation, access, or silence. Writing it here doesn't replace a counselor or a safety plan.

DAY 14 SACRED REFLECTION

There are no wrong answers here. Anger, doubt, and grief are allowed. You can tell God the truth before you know how to clean it up.

1. What pattern from my family am I most afraid I'm repeating? What's one thing I do differently already?

2. What agreement did I make in the dark that I'd like to bring into the light?

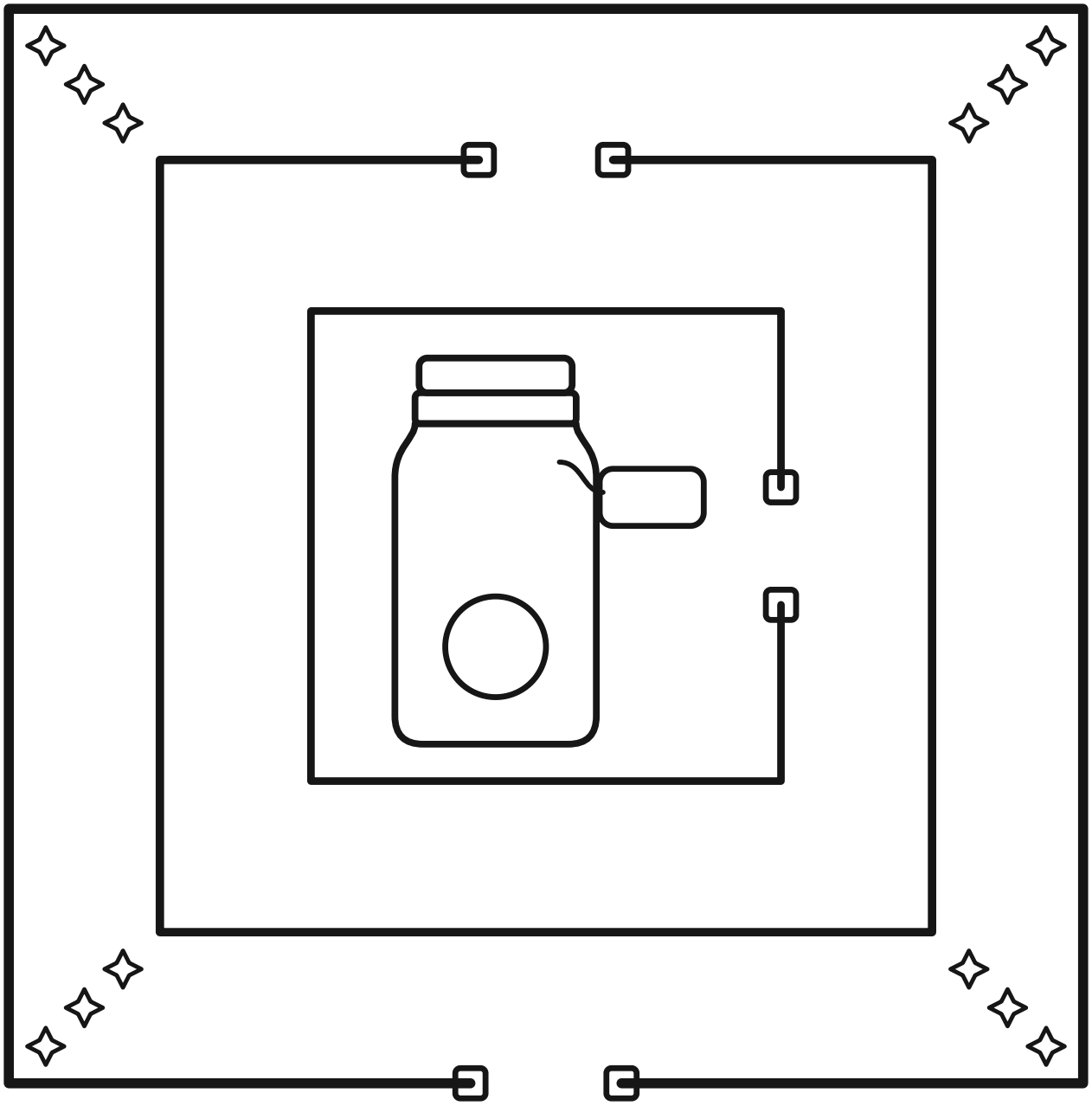
3. What do I want to protect, even if someone calls it selfish?

SOFT ACTION (one step, not five)

Pick **one** item from the "give back to God" column and say it out loud to God today. Pick **one** from the "not surrendering" column and tell one safe person. If you don't have a safe person yet, say it to the wall. Practice matters.

SUPPLICATION · A PRAYER FOR WHEN YOU CAN'T FIND THE WORDS

Father, thank You that You cancel what I can't pay and You don't charge me for what others did. I give back what isn't mine: the vows, the secrets, the anger I've been renting out. I keep what You have given me: my safety, my care, my no. Teach me to love without handing over the keys. Give me wise people for the hard places. I'm asking for a different pattern, and I'm willing to practice. In Jesus' name, amen.



*Notice the gates. Lines can protect without punishing. "...so that we would not be outwitted by Satan; for we are not ignorant of his designs." **2 Corinthians 2:11 (ESV)***

Color slowly or not at all. Keep your eyes open. Breathe out longer than you breathe in. There is no right way to do this.

DAY 17

Numb Was a Teacher

It never stole the pain. It rented you a few hours away from it.

S Psalm 34:18; John 15:1–2; Galatians 5:19–21 · E 1 Enoch 7:1, 8:3; Jubilees 10:10–13 · #truthmode

SANCTUARY (optional · 2 minutes)

Wrap your hands around something warm: a mug, a washcloth, your own hands. Breathe out slowly, like you're fogging a window. Do that three times. You can stop at any point.

God, I'm not going to dress this up for You. Meet me in the real version. Amen.

> "I am the true vine, and my Father is the vinedresser. Every branch of mine that does not bear fruit he takes away, and every branch that does bear fruit he prunes, that it may bear more fruit." **John 15:1–2 (ESV)** S
>
> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted and saves the crushed in spirit." **Psalm 34:18 (ESV)** S

I won't pretend I don't know why somebody uses. I know what it's like to want the noise to stop. This page is not about shaming you, and relapse does not make you disposable. #human

1 Enoch 7:1 and 8:3 describe the Watchers teaching charms, enchantments, and "the cutting of roots and plants." E In Galatians 5:19–21, Paul lists "sorcery" among the works of the flesh. The Greek word there is *pharmakeia*, where we get the word *pharmacy*. S In Paul's world it covered drugging, charms, and enchantment together.

My application: numbing is a **counterfeit of rest and comfort**, a shortcut that rents you relief and sends the bill later. A That is not the same thing as medicine. Jubilees 10:10–13 has angels teaching Noah healing remedies from plants. E **If a doctor prescribed it, keep taking it.** Never stop prescribed medication, including medication for opioid or alcohol use disorder, because of this book. Treatment is part of the vineyard, not a lack of faith.

Addiction is also a health condition, with real changes in the body and brain, which is why "just pray harder" fails people. Prayer belongs *beside* treatment, not instead of it. #truthmode

Jesus says the Father prunes every branch that bears fruit (John 15:2). S Notice who gets pruned: *branches still attached*. A Pruning is not punishment. It's cutting what drains, so the branch can bear. It can hurt. It does not mean you're being thrown out.

So we won't ask "why are you so weak?" We'll ask what numbing was *doing for you*, and what else can do that job without costing you your life.

Truths to stand on: Relapse doesn't make me disposable. · Needing relief is not a character flaw. · Pruning means I'm still attached.

Job Interview for the Habit

Treat the habit like an employee. What was its job? Is it doing it? What's it costing you? No shame, just facts.

1 · IT PROMISED ME…

☐ Sleep ☐ Courage ☐ Quiet in my head ☐ Belonging ☐ Feeling something ☐ Feeling nothing

☐ Escape from a person ☐ Other: _____

2 · THE REAL JOB UNDERNEATH WAS… (CIRCLE ONE)

SAFETY · REST · CONNECTION · CONTROL · RELIEF FROM SHAME

3 · THE BILL SO FAR

It has cost me _____, _____, and _____.

4 · A DIFFERENT WORKER FOR THE SAME JOB (TRY ONE THIS WEEK)

Safety → tell one person where I am tonight. **Rest** → fixed bedtime, dark room, no screens for 20 minutes. **Connection** → one text to a safe person. **Control** → decide one small thing today. **Relief from shame** → say the truth to God or a counselor out loud.

My replacement for the job above: _____

IF I SLIP, MY PLAN IS…

I'll call _____ . My first words to myself will be "_____."

The next small step after that is _____ . Treatment line: SAMHSA 1-800-662-4357.

WHAT THE HABIT TAUGHT ME (optional)

DAY 17 SACRED REFLECTION

There are no wrong answers here. Anger, doubt, and grief are allowed. You can tell God the truth before you know how to clean it up.

1. What was I really asking that habit to do for me?

2. What is the hardest feeling I've been trying not to feel?

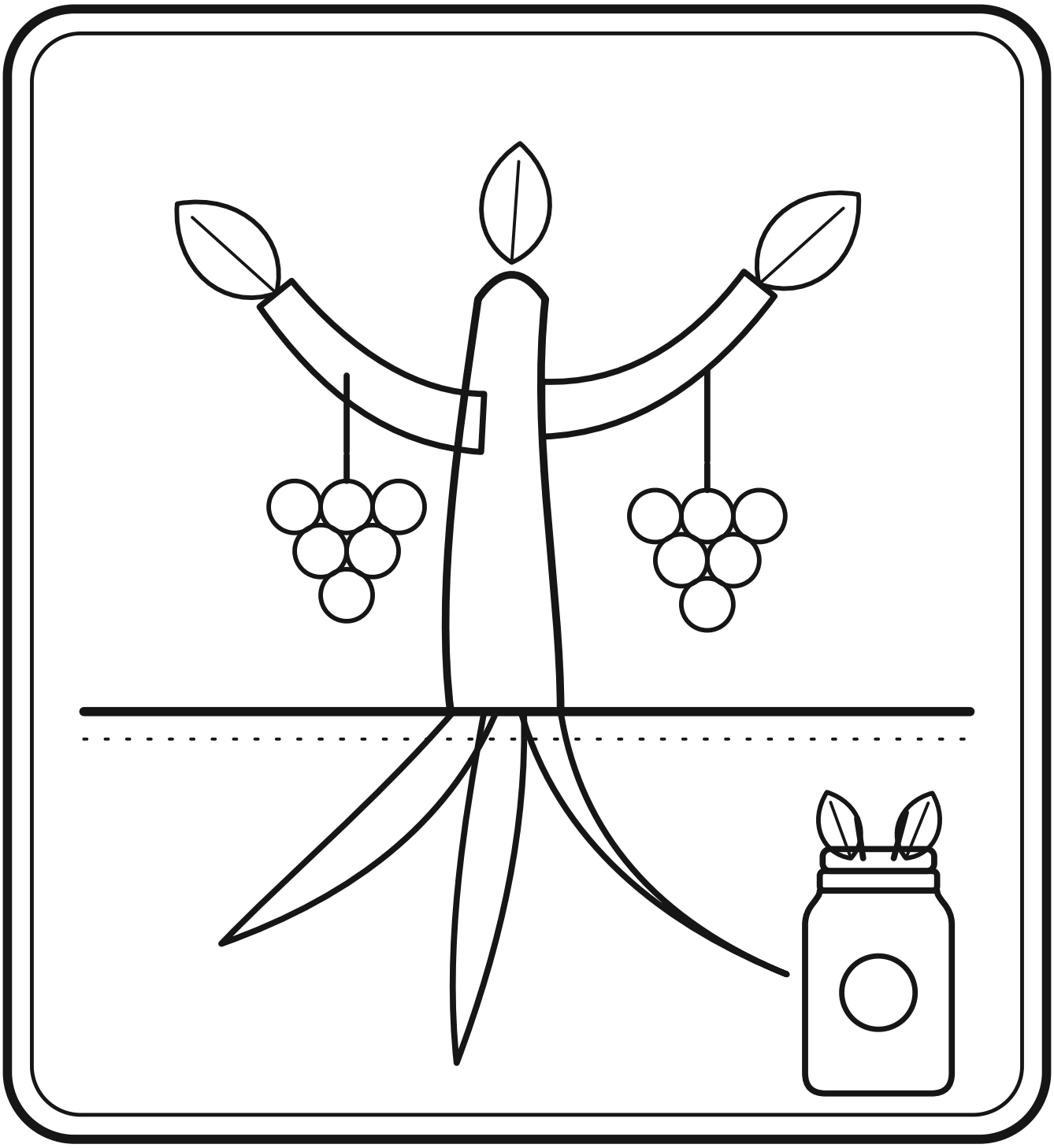
3. What would pruning, cutting off one thing that drains me, look like this month?

SOFT ACTION (one step, not five)

Choose **one** replacement from the list and try it once today. Not forever. Once. If you want treatment, call or text SAMHSA at 1-800-662-4357, or ask your doctor. If a call is too much, text a friend: "Can you sit with me while I call?"

SUPPLICATION · A PRAYER FOR WHEN YOU CAN'T FIND THE WORDS

Father, You know what I was trying to get away from. Thank You that You don't shame me for wanting relief. Teach me to bring my pain to You and to the people You've put in reach, before I bring it anywhere else. Where I need treatment, give me courage to ask. Where I've slipped, hold me without letting me go. Prune what drains me, and keep me attached to You. In the name of Jesus, amen.



Roots, branches, fruit. "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted." **Psalm 34:18 (ESV)**

Color slowly or not at all. Keep your eyes open. Breathe out longer than you breathe in. There is no right way to do this.

DAY 27

Won’t Bow

They will threaten to cut you off. Count how many times they already did.

S Daniel 3:16–25; Psalm 27:10; 1 Peter 2:9 · E Books of Meqabyan · #futureyou

SANCTUARY (optional · 2 minutes)

Sit with your back against something solid. Feel it hold you. Look around and name five things that are in the room right now. Say: “I am here. This is now.” If that doesn’t help, press your feet down and push.

God, I’m tired of being afraid of people. Stand with me. Amen.

> “If this be so, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace, and he will deliver us out of your hand, O king. But if not, be it known to you, O king, that we will not serve your gods or worship the golden image that you have set up.” **Daniel 3:17–18 (ESV)** S
>
> “For my father and my mother have forsaken me, but the LORD will take me in.” **Psalm 27:10 (ESV)** S

“Fall in line or lose everybody.” That’s the oldest pressure play there is, and I’ve heard it from people who claimed to love me. #human

The Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo canon includes the Books of Meqabyan. They are not the same as the Maccabees books in other Bibles. They carry stories of believers under pressure from rulers to give in. E I’m not going to quote them here until we read them together carefully in the full edition. What I can teach today comes from the 66-book Bible, and it says the same thing.

In Daniel 3, three young men are told to bow or burn. Notice what they say: God is able to deliver, *“but if not,”* they still won’t bow. S Their faith doesn’t depend on the outcome. And when the king looks into the furnace, he sees four men “unbound, walking in the midst of the fire, and they are not hurt” (Daniel 3:25). S They weren’t alone in it.

Three honest corrections. A **First**, refusing to bow doesn’t mean confronting someone dangerous. It can be silent. It can be a closed door and a plan. They answered the king when asked. They didn’t go looking for a fight. **Second**, leaving or resisting an abuser can be the most dangerous time. Call a domestic violence advocate (1-800-799-7233, or text START to 88788) for a safety plan *before* you announce anything. **Third**, standing on your own two feet is not the same as standing alone. Isolation is the enemy’s tool. Independence is you choosing safe people.

First Peter 2:9 says you are “a chosen race, a royal priesthood… a people for his own possession.” S Corner to crown is a picture, not a promise of ease: your identity reaches past the role you survived in. A

Truths to stand on: I can refuse and stay safe. · Being cut off by people does not cut me off from God. · Standing firm is not the same as standing alone.

Pressure Ladder

Pressure has a purpose. Name it. Write a line you can say, or say silently. Then write where you're safe if it escalates.

Pressure I've heard	What it's trying to do	My line	Where I'm safe if it escalates
"You'll be alone."	Isolate	I'd rather be alone than owned.	
"Nobody will believe you."	Silence	I don't need everyone to.	
"After all I did for you."	Guilt-debt	I can be grateful and still say no.	
"You're nothing without me."	Shrink	My worth did not start with you.	

Won't Bow · Will Bend

I will bend on… (preferences, schedule, tone, being right)	**I won't bow on…** (my safety, the truth, my faith, my body, my kids' safety)

The one thing about who I am that I will not trade: _____

Three people I can reach this week: _____ , _____ , _____

If no names come, that's honest too. Call a hotline, a counselor, a church you trust, or a recovery meeting, and write the number here: _____

DAY 27 SACRED REFLECTION

There are no wrong answers here. Anger, doubt, and grief are allowed. You can tell God the truth before you know how to clean it up.

1. Who or what have I been bowing to, and what did it cost me?

2. What's one place I can bend without losing myself?

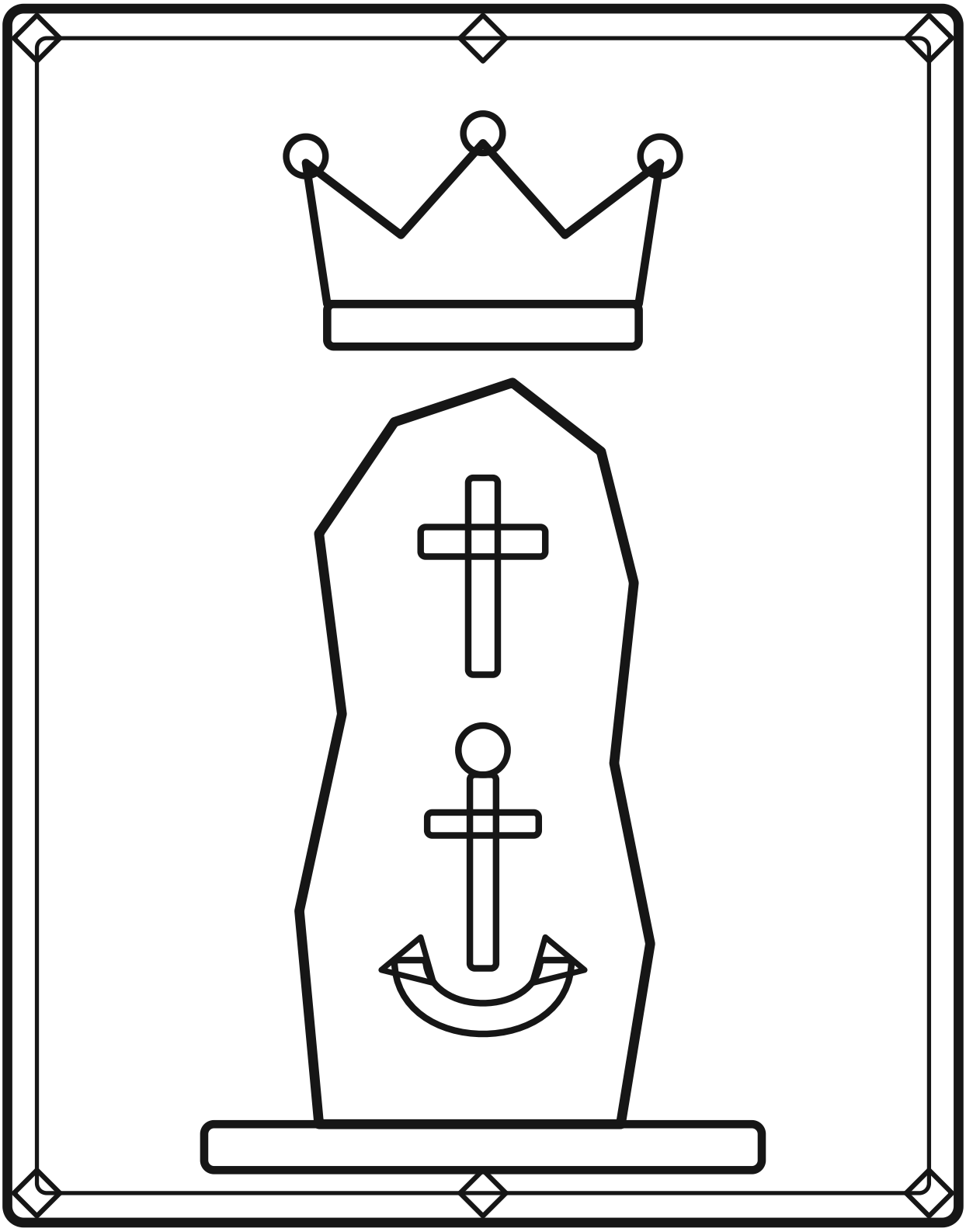
3. What would it mean for me to stand firm and stay safe at the same time?

SOFT ACTION (one step, not five)

Write one "won't bow" sentence on a card and put it somewhere only you will see it. Then pick one safe person and tell them one thing that's true. If sharing isn't safe yet, make a plan: **who, when, and what you'll say**. A plan counts.

SUPPLICATION · A PRAYER FOR WHEN YOU CAN'T FIND THE WORDS

Lord, You are able. And even when it doesn't go the way I hope, You are still God and I am still Yours. Give me the courage not to bow where I shouldn't, the wisdom to bend where I can, and the care to stay safe. Send people who tell me the truth. When I'm cut off, take me in. Remind me that my worth did not start with them and does not end with them. In Jesus' name, amen.



Corner to crown. The crown is a picture, not a promise of ease. "…a chosen race, a royal priesthood." ***1 Peter 2:9 (ESV)***

Color slowly or not at all. Keep your eyes open. Breathe out longer than you breathe in. There is no right way to do this.

Final Reflection & Progress Review

You've walked through five hard days. Slow down and look back. You don't have to answer everything.

1. Which day hit hardest, and why?

2. What is one thing I understand about my story that I didn't before?

3. What did I do, even once, that I wouldn't have done a month ago?

PROGRESS REVIEW · CHECK WHAT'S TRUE, NO POINTS FOR MORE

- ☐ I named a pattern in my life.
- ☐ I told one person something true.
- ☐ I colored a page.
- ☐ I told God something I'd been hiding.
- ☐ I ate, drank, or slept on purpose.
- ☐ I said "no" to something, even in my head.
- ☐ I asked for help or looked up a number.
- ☐ I skipped something to protect myself.

Skipping to protect yourself is a win. This list is not a score. It's a mirror.

> "Let us not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will reap, if we do not give up."
> **Galatians 6:9 (ESV)** S

Next-Step Challenge & Closing Prayer

You don’t have to rebuild your whole life before sundown. But we do need to choose what happens next. Pick **one** and circle it. Not all of them.

1. **Tell someone.** One true sentence to one safe person this week.
2. **Take care of the body.** One appointment, one call, or one meal and a bedtime.
3. **Make the plan.** Write who you’ll call, where you’ll go, and what you’ll say if things get worse.
4. **Repeat the tool.** Do Template Spotter, Sort the Jars, or the Pressure Ladder again on a day you need it.
5. **Ask for real care.** Call a counselor, treatment program, advocate, or pastor you trust.

My one next step is _____

I will do it by (date) _____ . I will tell _____ .

CLOSING PRAYER

Lord Jesus, thank You for walking me through these days. You saw the floor, and You didn’t leave me on it. Thank You for every honest word I wrote, every page I colored, and every time I stayed. I’m not done, and I’m not pretending to be. Help me take the next step, and the one after. Where I’m afraid, be near. Where I’ve been hurt, heal what only You can and send the people who can help with the rest. Plant me in a safe place and tend me, and let me bear fruit in Your time. Keep me from isolating, from numbing, and from bowing where I shouldn’t. Thank You that brokenness isn’t where I end. In Your name, amen.

You survived. Now we rebuild.

7 H E H 0 L Y R 3 U P

Certificate of Completion

This certifies that

PARTICIPANT NAME

has completed

Corner to Crown

Five Founding Days from the 30-Day Rebuild

Showing up counts. Skipping to protect yourself counts. You are still here.

DATE

SIGNATURE

You survived. Now we rebuild.

Where to Reach a Real Human

These are U.S. numbers. Services change, so double-check if one doesn't connect. If you're outside the U.S., search for your local crisis line, or ask a trusted person to help you find one.

Emergency	**911**
Suicide & Crisis Lifeline	**Call or text 988 (24/7)**
National Domestic Violence Hotline	**1-800-799-7233 · or text START to 88788 (24/7)**
National Human Trafficking Hotline	**1-888-373-7888 · or text 233733 (24/7)**
SAMHSA National Helpline (substance use & mental health treatment referral)	**1-800-662-4357 (free, confidential, 24/7)**

MY PEOPLE (FILL IN WHEN YOU CAN)

Safe person #1: _____ phone: _____

Safe person #2: _____ phone: _____

Counselor / pastor / advocate: _____ phone: _____

Place I can go if I'm not safe: _____

If you're helping a friend

You don't have to fix it. Believe them. Don't demand the whole story. Offer a ride, a meal, a phone number, and your company. Never pressure someone to leave, forgive, or "just pray." Ask what would help, and take your cues from them.

7HE H0LY R3UP · Corner to Crown · © 2026. This book is a tool beside real care, not a replacement for it.